
4.6 Unit 4, Topic D: Global Political Issues

Focus This topic examines key issues in recent global politics and how these issues are dealt with at a global level.

What students need to learn: *Students taking Unit 4, Topic D must learn all areas within the topic.*

Conflict, War and Terrorism

Key concepts	Content explanation
clash of civilisations 'war on terror' 'rogue' states weapons of mass destruction terrorism	■ Knowledge of the key conflicts in the modern world and an awareness of the sources of global conflict, especially linked to developments since 9/11, including issues to do with the so-called 'war on terror', nuclear proliferation and other weapons of mass destruction, and the spread and significance of global terrorism.

Poverty and Development

Key concepts	Content explanation
north-south divide neocolonialism development corruption	■ Knowledge of the nature and extent of global poverty, and a critical awareness of the effectiveness of attempts to reduce poverty through programmes of development, international aid and good governance.

Environmental Issues

Key concepts	Content explanation
environmental crisis ecology global commons sustainability	■ Knowledge of the nature and development of the global environmental crisis, especially linked to the issue of climate change, and an awareness of competing views about how these issues can best be tackled.

Human Rights

Key concepts	Content explanation
human rights international law minority rights humanitarian intervention	■ Knowledge of the role and significance of human rights in international/global politics, of how, and the extent to which, human rights are protected by international law and international courts. ■ Knowledge of the growth of humanitarian intervention in recent international politics and of the case for and against forcible humanitarian intervention. ■ Knowledge of the way human rights have been interpreted and used by different cultural groups.